

Government Schemes & Startup Support

Knowledge base for Startup AI Agent — India/Karnataka focus

1. Startup India ecosystem

Startup India is a Government of India initiative under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT). The Startup India portal provides information on central government schemes, state and UT startup policies, funding, mentorship and ecosystem initiatives.

Useful official areas include Central Government Schemes, State/UT Startup Policies, Seed Fund Scheme, Startup India Investor Connect, Fund of Funds, MAARG mentorship and BHASKAR.

2. Startup India Seed Fund Scheme (SISFS)

SISFS provides financial assistance for proof of concept, prototype development, product trials, market entry and commercialisation. The scheme is designed to help early-stage startups reach a stage where they can raise investment or obtain loans.

Current official scheme information says an eligible startup must be DPIIT-recognised and incorporated not more than two years ago at the time of application, with a product/service idea having market fit, viable commercialisation and scope for scaling. The scheme also has technology-related requirements and other eligibility conditions.

Official source: <https://seedfund.startupindia.gov.in/> and <https://seedfund.startupindia.gov.in/faq>

3. Karnataka startup ecosystem

Karnataka has a dedicated startup ecosystem supported by the Karnataka Innovation and Technology Society (KITS) under the Department of Electronics, Information Technology, Biotechnology and Science & Technology. The 2026 Karnataka state ecosystem report describes support across incentives, Centres of Excellence, Technology Business Incubators, Common Instrumentation Facilities, incubation, mentor and investor networks and international exposure.

The Startup India state-policy portal provides Karnataka policy information. Because policy versions and incentives can change, the chatbot should always identify the policy year/source when giving Karnataka-specific information.

4. How an entrepreneur should use scheme information

First identify the startup stage: idea, prototype, early traction or scaling. Then identify sector, location, DPIIT recognition status, funding requirement and intended use of funds. Match these facts against official eligibility criteria rather than assuming that every scheme applies.

Recommended chatbot response format: Scheme name → purpose → likely stage → key eligibility → benefit/support → application route → official source → verification note.

5. Official sources for the chatbot

Startup India: <https://www.startupindia.gov.in/>

Startup India Seed Fund Scheme: <https://seedfund.startupindia.gov.in/>

Startup India state policies: <https://www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/state-startup-policies.html>

Karnataka startup ecosystem information:

https://www.startupindia.gov.in/srf/portal/SRF_2026_Result_page/Karnataka_State_Report.pdf

Important: Government schemes, eligibility, application windows, funding amounts and policies can change. This document is a knowledge-base summary, not legal or financial advice. Users should verify current details on the official source before applying.